

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Indestructible'

Toh 524 · Derge Kangyur

མ་འིང་གིས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་ཕགས་པའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 524 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as "The Indestructible" and bearing the related title "The Great Lord" (Sanskrit: Mahāpati or similar), belonging to the broad category of dhāraṇī and ritual scripture. The text recounts a scene in which Śakra, lord of the gods, approaches the Buddha at Vaiśālī near the Monkey Pond and requests a teaching to protect him from the ongoing attacks of the asuras, providing the narrative occasion for the Buddha to impart a powerful dhāraṇī. As is typical of this genre, the text combines a framing story with a protective formula intended to confer spiritual and worldly benefit on those who receive and recite it. It was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla together with the renowned Tibetan editor-translator Ye shes sde, and was later revised to conform to standardized orthographic conventions, placing it among the carefully edited canonical dhāraṇī collections of the Kangyur.

The dhāraṇī called "The Great Lord" is complete.

This was translated, edited, and definitively established by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the great editor-translator the monk Ye shes sde, and was further revised in accordance with the new orthographic conventions.

In the Tibetan language:

The noble dhāraṇī called "The Indestructible."

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Vaiśālī, in the pavilion beside the Monkey Pond. At that time Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the asuras are attacking and harming me, and it has come to pass that the asuras and I have long been at enmity, without friendship. Therefore I beseech the Blessed One to teach me the Dharma that will bring me lasting benefit and lasting happiness." When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to Śakra, lord of the gods:

"Therefore, O Kauśika, receive this knowledge-mantra of mine called 'The Indestructible.' It is as follows: tadyathā — urbapa, nirbisirbī, urpurpure, hūle hūle, dekhume, pratyaṃgama āgaccha mahā māyāri nāma — protect me from

all fears, all harm, and all their retinues. Protect! Protect! sarva kāya vāka
manaś carite svāhā."

The Blessed One, pleased, having declared these words, Śakra, lord of the
gods, was filled with joy.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering and do not admit of a confident Sanskrit reconstruction throughout; the rendering here follows the Tibetan phonetically while restoring recognizable Sanskrit forms where the underlying text is transparent. The phrase rendered "new orthographic conventions" refers to the standardization of Tibetan spelling carried out under the imperial revision committees, a well-known historical process.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.